

OHATS Path Forward

Organization Health Assessment Tool & Survey
Archive Overview and Recommendations for Future Research Teams

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What Is OHATS

OHATS (Organization Health Assessment Tool & Survey) was a web-based system designed for the **Tutor/Mentor Connection** (T/MC) by researcher Steve Roussos between 1998 and 2002. Its purpose was to help youth-serving nonprofit organizations self-assess their performance against the four strategic pillars that Daniel F. Bassill used to guide the T/MC mission:

1. **Collect information** — document what organizations do and who they reach.
2. **Spread information** — share knowledge across the nonprofit network.
3. **Build capacity** — develop organizational skills and leadership.
4. **Evaluate impact** — measure outcomes and adapt strategy.

OHATS asked organizations to document what they did in relation to one or more of these pillars. The vision was to aggregate those self-assessments across the network so that T/MC could see which organizations were active in which pillars, track change over time, and identify where capacity-building support was most needed.

The system was active in some form from approximately 2000 to 2002. Rebuild attempts occurred in 2007 (internal notes) and 2008 (Ganesh Mahalingam, external developer; SVHATS 2.0 specification by V. Helde). None of the rebuilds resulted in a publicly deployed, sustained system.

Why OHATS matters now (April 2026): In the April 22, 2026 client meeting, Daniel F. Bassill confirmed that OHATS is a priority for the next semester project. He described the data as directly connected to his four strategic pillars and said that visualizing OHATS assessment data would be “data-visualization-heavy” in a way that is ideal for the E483/E583 course. The Spring 2026 team did preliminary cleanup of the archive; a future team should begin with this document and the folder inventory below.

Archive Location and Inventory

All OHATS materials are stored at:

ProjectFiles/OHATS-TMC-SteveRoussos 1998-2002-20260422T193300Z-3-001/
OHATS-TMC-SteveRoussos 1998-2002/

Planning Correspondence (1998–2001)

These documents trace the origin and design of OHATS from Roussos’s initial letter to T/MC through the first operational period.

File	Description
RossosLetter-toTMC-12-6-1998.pdf	Roussos's initial letter proposing evaluation system to T/MC
S.Roussos-letter 12-6-1998.pdf	Companion letter
S.Roussos-letter-collaboration.ideas-1-22-1999.pdf	Early collaboration ideas
S.Roussos-letter-grants.ideas-1999.pdf	Grant-funding concepts for the system
S.Roussos-email-.communication-1999.pdf	1999 email communications
S.Roussos-email-.idea-sharing-1999.pdf	Idea-sharing exchange
S.Roussos-email-ICQ-net.communication-1999.pdf	ICQ-based communication
ConfPresentation-IYP-funding-Roussos-draft-1999.pdf	Conference presentation, IYP funding

System Design and Workplans (2000–2002)

These documents define what OHATS was supposed to do and how it was built. **Start here when trying to understand the system schema.**

File	Description
Workplan-to-establish-TMC-OHATS-4-24-2000-Roussos.pdf	Primary workplan for establishing OHATS
WorkPlan-TMC-EvalSystem-6-9-2000.pdf	Evaluation system workplan
OHATS for TMC-S.Roussos-6-2000.pdf	Core OHATS description document
OHATS - what is it.doc	Plain-language explanation of OHATS
OHATS development - notes - 2000-01.pdf	Developer notes during active build
OHATS-draft-comments-1-7-2001.pdf	Draft review comments
OHATS improvement specs - 2-21-2001-Roussos.pdf	Improvement specifications
OHATS planning - Roussos email 6-21-2001.pdf	Planning email
OHATS - Procedures for Dev & Application - 3-2002.pdf	Procedures document
Mgt-Info-Learning-System-MILS-forCC-7-27-2000-Roussos.pdf	Broader information system context
CC-MtInfo-LearningSystem-S.Roussos-7-27-2000.pdf	Companion MILS document
MILS for KidsConnection-Draft-8-3-2000-Roussos.pdf	Application to kids programs

Reports and Outcomes (2000–2005)

File	Description
TMC-OHATS Report-March2002.pdf	Primary operational report
OHATS-files/TMC_OHATS_Report_Sep-00_thru_Mar-02.pdf	Key data source: full 18-month report Mar 2002
OHATS items reported by G. Schoen for TMC 2000–2001.pdf	Items logged by staff
TMC OHATS development 3-17-2003.pdf	2003 development status
Long-term-impact-CC-TMC-slides-for-discussion 2005.pdf	2005 retrospective slides
TQM chart-circa2000-showing people involved.pdf	TQM organizational chart

Funding Documents

File	Description
Request-for-2ndYr-Funding-OHATS-2001.pdf	Request for second-year funding
SRoussos-contract-building-evaluation-OHATS-2000-01.pdf	Roussos contract
Research and Information System Associate (RISA)...pdf	RISA role description for OHATS
Mentoring Network Grant-abstract-draft 3-1999.pdf	Grant abstract
Mentoring Network Grant-problem description-draft 3-1999.pdf	Grant problem statement
Workplan for TMC Tech-Intern-Summer2001.pdf	Intern workplan
Endorsement of S. Roussos - 2011.pdf	2011 endorsement letter

Rebuild Attempts (2007–2008)

File	Description
OHATS rebuild - 2-16-2007.pdf	2007 rebuild plan
OHATS rebuild - screen shots - 2007.pdf	Screen shots of rebuilt version
OHATS rebuild - screen shots w notes - 2007.pdf	Annotated screen shots
OHATS 2007 developer - Ganesh Mahalingam-12-24-2007.pdf	Developer communication
SVHATS_2.0.doc	Most complete requirements SVHATS 2.0 spec
SVHATS-JourneyMapping-V.Helde-12-4-2008.pdf	Journey-mapping for 2008 redesign
OHATS-files/OHATS08report.doc	2008 status report
OHATS-files/OHATS10_26.doc, OHATS10_29.doc	2008 working documents
OHATS-files/OHATS 3_19_08.doc, OHATS 8_16_08.doc	2008 meeting notes
OHATS-files/OHATS_-_Advanced_Features_-_Price_Info[1].pdf	Pricing for advanced features
OHATS-files/TMC Flowchart1.doc	System flowchart
OHATS-files/TMC goals-GISrev.doc	Goals document with GIS revision

OHATS Source Code (ASP.NET, circa 2002)

The OHATS/ subfolder contains the original ASP.NET web application. **Do not attempt to run this code**—it is legacy technology (Microsoft FrontPage / .NET 1.x, circa 2002) and serves only as a documentation artifact showing the system’s data schema and page structure.

Key pages that reveal the data model:

- `Default.aspx` — Home/login
- `EventInfo.aspx`, `Eventsearchcontent.aspx` — Event tracking
- `Contactinfo.aspx`, `ContactInfoListcontent.aspx` — Organization contacts
- `Metrics.aspx`, `AdvancedMetrics.aspx` — Metric reporting

- `CredentialMetrics.aspx`, `CredentialsAdvancedMetrics.aspx` — Credential tracking
- `Update.aspx`, `MyContacts.aspx` — Self-service update

The page names map directly to the data categories OHATS tracked: **events, contacts, metrics, and credentials**—each corresponding to one or more of Bassill’s four strategic pillars.

Data Extraction Opportunities

Where Data Actually Lives

OHATS was a live web application; the database it wrote to is not included in this archive. What survives are:

1. **Narrative reports** describing aggregate results (`TMC_OHATS_Report_Sep-00_thru_Mar-02.pdf`, `TMC-OHATS Report-March2002.pdf`).
2. **Working documents** with structured lists of items, people, and organizations (OHATS items reported by G. Schoen...pdf, OHATS development - notes - 2000-01.pdf).
3. **The source code schema** (visible from `.aspx` page names and the `SVHATS_2.0.doc` requirements).
4. **The 2007–2008 rebuild screen shots**, which show actual data populated in the system’s UI during those rebuild periods.

Recommended Extraction Steps for a Future Team

1. **Read the 18-month report first.** `OHATS-files/TMC_OHATS_Report_Sep-00_thru_Mar-02.pdf` is the primary record of what the system actually captured. Extract any tabular data (organization names, pillars addressed, assessment scores) into a CSV for analysis.
2. **Read `SVHATS_2.0.doc`.** This is the most complete requirements specification. It defines the data model that the 2008 rebuild was targeting. Use it to design a modern schema that could receive OHATS-style data.
3. **Review the 2007 screen shots with notes.** `OHATS rebuild - screen shots w notes - 2007.pdf` shows the UI with annotated data. This may contain organization names and assessment values that can be extracted manually.
4. **Cross-reference with conference attendance data.** The conference attendance dataset (6,410 records, 2,163 unique organizations) covers the same 1994–2014 period. Joining OHATS-assessed organizations to the conference attendance data would reveal which organizations both attended conferences *and* participated in self-assessment—a proxy for “most engaged” network members.
5. **Design the data entry tool.** The long-term goal is a modern replacement for OHATS: a Django (or similar) form that lets organizations self-report against Bassill’s four pillars.

The `MappingAndAnalyzingParticipation` and `YourConferenceNetwork` codebases provide a technical starting point.

Recommended Visualization Directions

Once structured OHATS data is extracted or collected, the following visualizations would be high-impact for Bassill’s stakeholders:

1. **Pillar coverage heatmap.** Rows = organizations; columns = the four strategic pillars. Color encodes self-reported engagement level (e.g., never, partially, consistently). This directly answers “who is doing what?”
2. **Pillar distribution by SNA sector.** Do Program-sector organizations prioritize different pillars than Foundation or Business orgs? A stacked bar or grouped chart answers this and connects OHATS findings to the existing conference attendance SNA categories.
3. **Timeline of OHATS use.** A simple time-series showing which organizations reported in which years (2000–2002, and if data exists from 2007–2008) would show engagement patterns over the system’s lifetime.
4. **OHATS × conference co-attendance network.** Overlay OHATS participation onto the org-org co-attendance network already built in Kumu.io. Organizations that both attended conferences *and* self-assessed become a highlighted subset of the full network—visualizing the most engaged segment.
5. **Radar/spider chart per organization.** For individual organizations that completed OHATS, a radar chart showing scores across the four pillars gives Bassill a one-page org profile.

Technical Handoff Notes

- The ASP.NET source code in `OHATS/` is informational only. Do not attempt to run, compile, or modernize it.
- The `SVHATS_2.0.doc` and `OHATS-files/TMC Flowchart1.doc` are the best references for system design intent.
- Any new OHATS data entry should be confirmed with Bassill before development. He has strong views on category definitions and pillar assignments (see April 22, 2026 transcript in `ProjectFiles/transcript_video2125685008.txt`).
- The existing Django codebase (`MappingAndAnalyzingParticipation/`) can be extended with a new Django app for OHATS data—the ORM, `load_data` pattern, and export endpoints are all reusable.
- Connect with Bassill via tutormentor1@gmail.com and review the “Strategy” concept map on tutormentorexchange.net (under Tutor/Mentor Connection → Strategy) before beginning any OHATS visualization work.

- Review the full entry in `ProjectFiles/future_team_suggestions.tex` (Section 4.1, “OHATS data integration”) for additional context.

Connection to the Broader Project

OHATS is not a standalone project—it is the next layer of the same ecosystem the Spring 2026 team built. The four-pillar strategy that OHATS tracked is visible in the Kumu concept maps Bassill showed in the April 22 meeting. The conference attendance data already documents *who* was involved; OHATS would document *what they did* and *how well*. Together, they answer the question Bassill has been asking for three decades: who needs to be in the network, and are they doing the work that makes the network effective?

A future team that connects these two datasets—attendance + assessment—will have produced something qualitatively more powerful than either alone.